

Certyfikat PMP: Stakeholders Engagement

**The Alignment Engine:
Frameworks for Expectation Management**

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The Asymmetry of Project Dynamics

In practice, managing stakeholder expectations is significantly more complex than managing project team members. Stakeholders often reside higher in the organizational hierarchy and introduce variable, subjective requirements.

Project Team Members

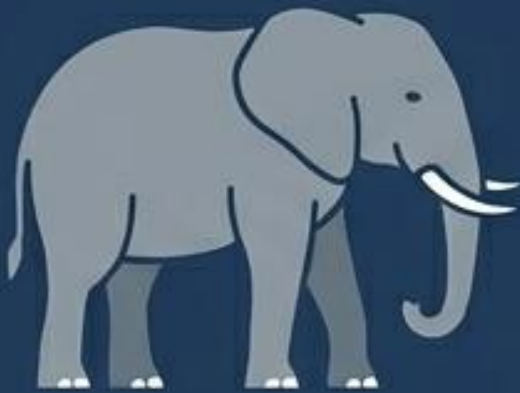
Authority Level:	Subordinate or matrixed to PM
Communication Needs:	Task-oriented, operational
Predictability:	High (bound by project roles)
Primary Management Tactic:	Direction and task management

Stakeholders

Authority Level:	Often managers, directors, or executives higher in the food chain
Communication Needs:	Lots of communication in every form you can provide
Predictability:	Low (driven by distinct organizational goals and subjective perspectives)
Primary Management Tactic:	Expectation alignment and consensus building

The Communication Gap: Hearing What We Want to Hear

Objective Concept:
Hard to misinterpret.



Subjective Concept:
High room for interpretation.
Requires repetition and verification.



Sender Responsibility

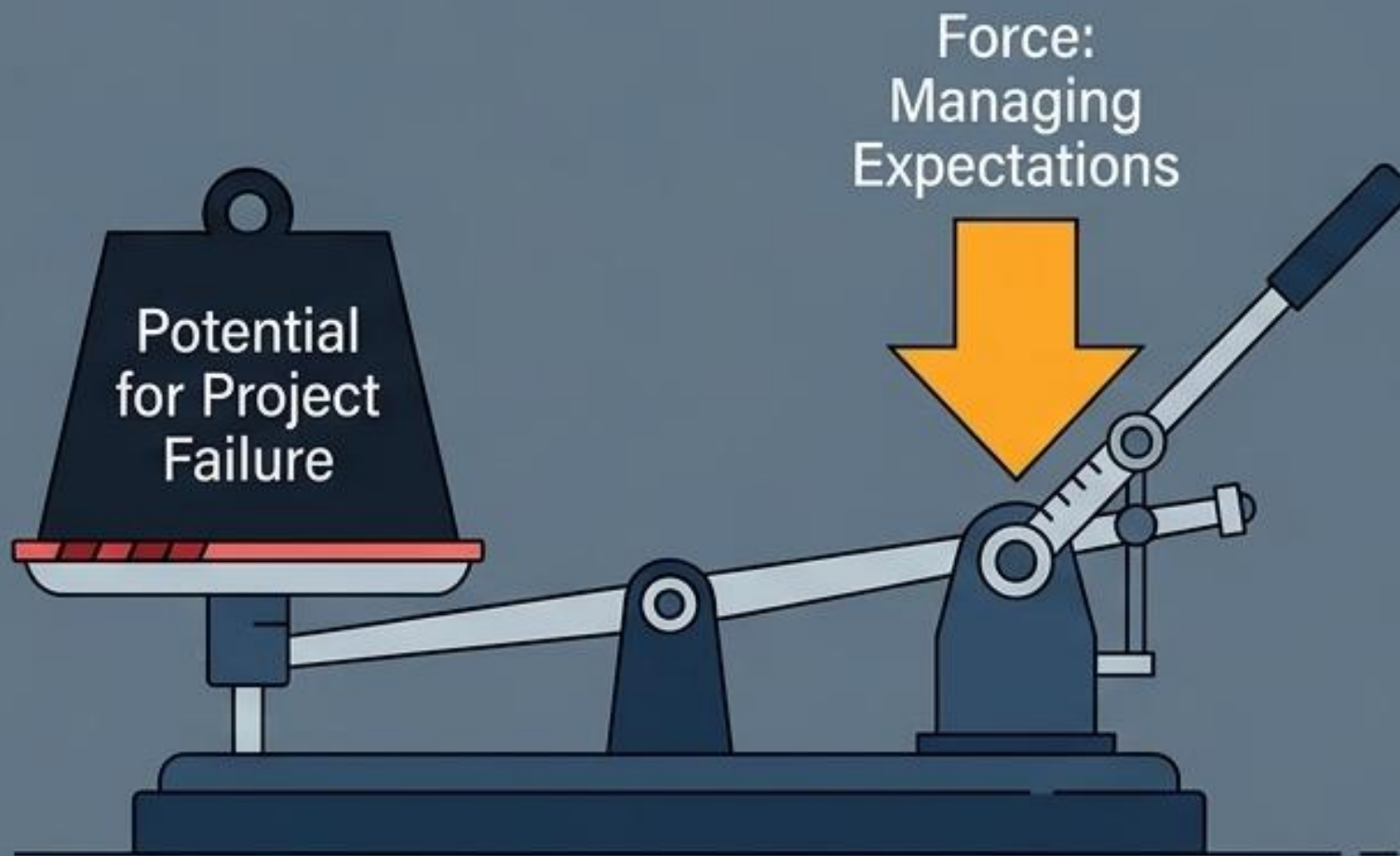
Transmit clear, concise, and complete messages.
Ensure language aligns with stakeholder understanding.

Receiver Responsibility

Ensure correct understanding of the message.

The PMBOK® Mandate: Expectation Management

Exam Spotlight: According to the PMBOK® Guide, it is the project manager's direct responsibility to manage stakeholder expectations.



Decreases the potential for project failure.



Increases the probability of meeting project goals.

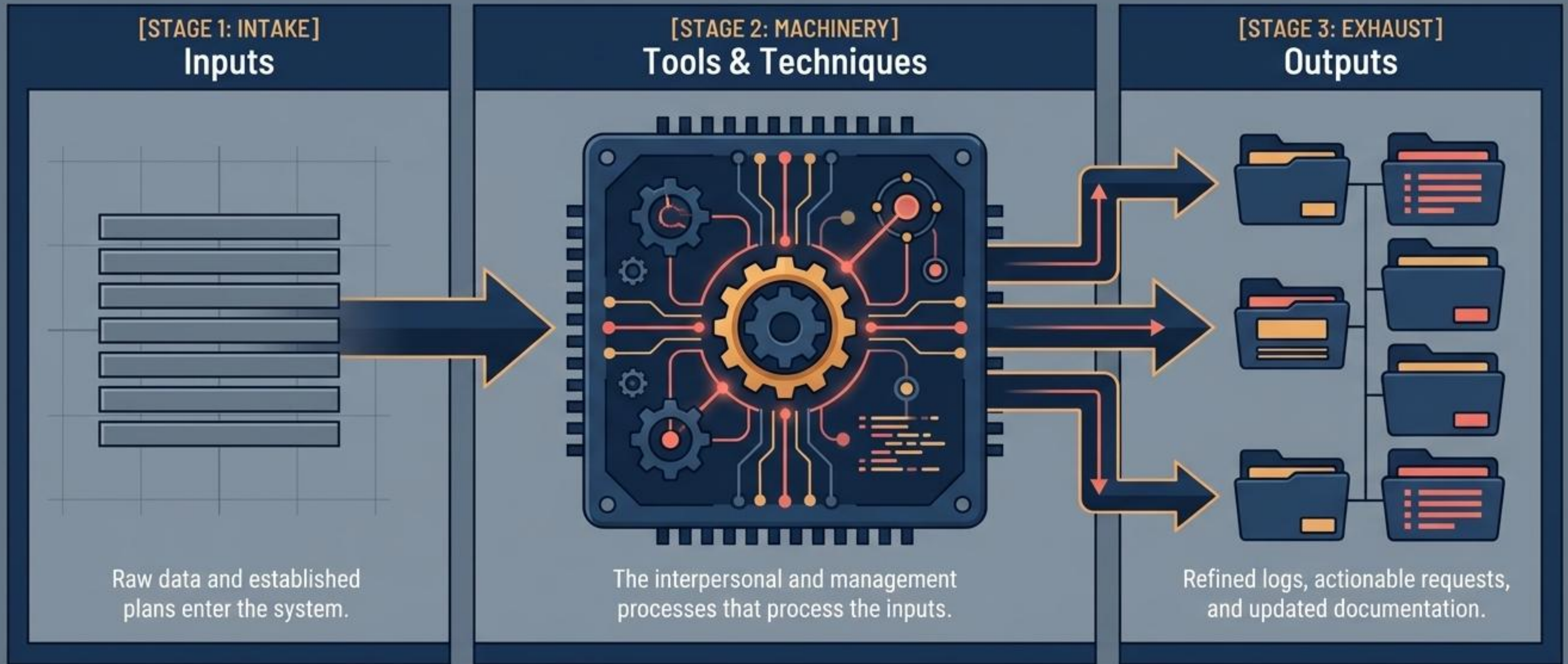


Ensures issues are resolved in a timely manner.



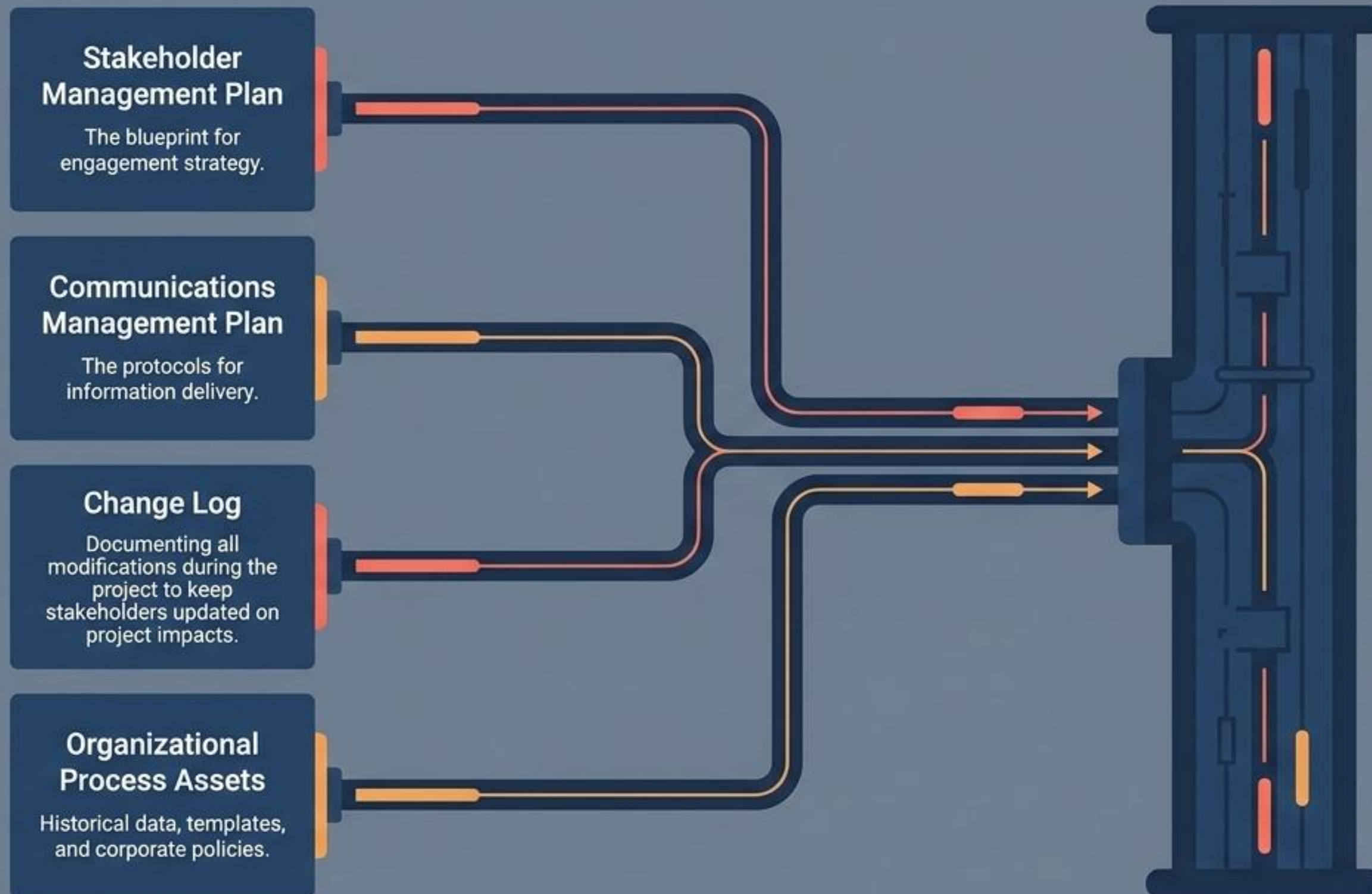
Limits disruptions during active project execution.

The Alignment Engine: Process Architecture



This process ensures satisfaction of stakeholder needs, resolves issues, and manages concerns in anticipation of potential problems.

System Intake: Critical Inputs



The Interpersonal Toolkit (Tools & Techniques)



System Output: The Action-Driven Issue Log

Change Requests

Project Management
Plan Updates

Project Documents
Updates

OPA Updates

Issue Log

Expanded Focus: The Issue Log



Exam Distinction: The issue log in this process acts as an Action Item Log. It is used to promote communication and ensure a shared understanding among stakeholders and the team.

Mechanical Rules for the Log:

1. Rank by **urgency**.

2. Rank by **potential impact**.

3. Assign a **responsible party**.

4. Define a firm **due date** for resolution.

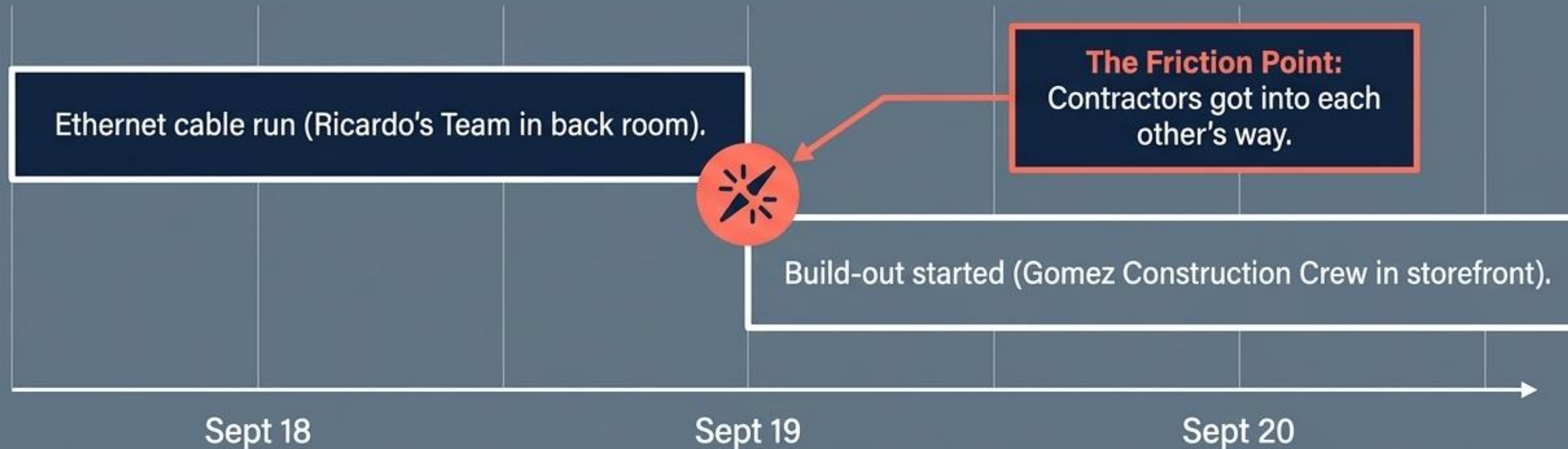
Live Diagnostic: Kitchen Heaven

Action Item Log



Item	Owner	Resolution Date	Status / Urgency / Impact
Call cable vendor	Ricardo	9/14	Closed
T1 connection status (Phone company unresponsive)	Ricardo	Pending	Urgency: High (Blocks Jan 21 Hardware Testing)
Build-out begins	Jake	Pending	In Progress
Gomez Construction Crew Emergency	Jake	--	Impact: Low (Replaced by another team member, schedule secure).
Gourmet Food Supplier Bankrupt	Jill	--	Low to Budget (Tracking new supplier). High to Operations

System Stress Test: Managing Fast-Tracking



To keep the project on schedule, the build-out started on the final day of the cable run. This technique is known as Fast Tracking. While it saves time, it generates minor stakeholder issues (contractor friction) that must be captured in the status report and actively managed by the PM.

Project Control Room: December Status Review

Procurements & Quality (Jake)

Gomez Construction payment request processed for Nov 30.

Risk Mitigated:

Hired independent inspector before city inspection to inspection to guarantee code compliance and prevent schedule delays.

Technical & Testing (Ricardo)

Issue Closed:

T1 Connection issue cleared, date set.

Fixed-price contract on hardware/IT supplies in sign-off.

Store Operations (Jill)

Change Request Logged:

Costs for new gourmet supplier higher than original vendor. Minimal hit to project budget, impacts ongoing operations.

Procurement Clarity: The First Line of Defense

A critical success factor for expectation management happens before work even begins: the contract. Disputes almost always trace back to unclear, imprecise documentation.



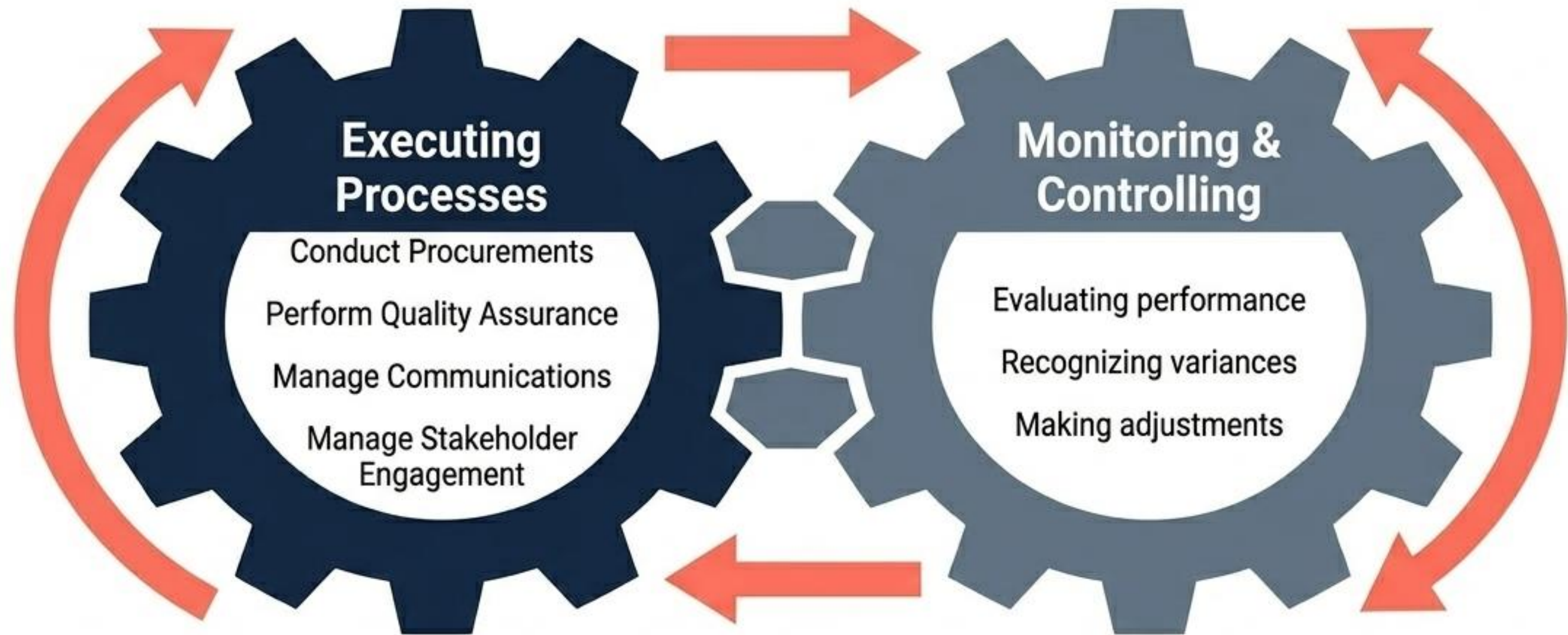
Contracting Best Practices:

- ✓ Use clear, concise, and specific language.
- ✓ Break down project requirements far enough to be strictly measurable.
- ✓ Define deliverables with criteria that allow inspection for compliance prior to final acceptance.

Life Cycle Stages:

Requirement → Requisition → Solicitation → Award

Macro-System Synthesis: The Iterative Engine



The Stakeholder Engagement process does not operate in a vacuum. Executing and Monitoring & Controlling are heavily iterative. As the project progresses, execution data feeds into controls. When adjustments are required, the process loops back through Execution to get the project back on track.